

REPETITION

Repeating a word or phrase for effect



1 What is it?

Repetition (rep-ih-TISH-un)

Repetition is when a writer **deliberately repeats** a word, phrase, or idea to emphasise it, build rhythm, or drill a point into the reader's mind.

word/phrase + repeated + on purpose

2 See it in action

Famous speech

"I have a dream..." — repeated again and again to build power and momentum.

Building urgency

Run. Run. Run. Don't look back, just run.

In advertising

"Because you're worth it. You're worth it."

Emotional emphasis

"Never, never, never give up," she said firmly.



Look here!

Ask yourself: **would removing the repeated word change the meaning or the feeling?** If it would lose its power, that repetition is deliberate and worth analysing.

FUN FACT

The "rule of three" (a specific kind of repetition — repeating an idea three times, like "blood, sweat and tears") is one of the most powerful patterns in speeches, jokes, and stories across every culture.

3 Why writers use it

Repetition helps writers: drill an idea into the reader's memory, build emotional intensity, create a rhythmic or chant-like effect, and signal that something is genuinely important.

Repetition is one of the most common techniques in speeches, because hearing something more than once makes it stick — think of any famous slogan you know by heart.

4 Where you'll spot it

Political speeches

Leaders repeat key phrases so they end up quoted in every headline the next day.

Song lyrics

Choruses rely almost entirely on repetition to become catchy and memorable.



Watch out!

Repetition has to be **deliberate** to count as a technique! If a writer accidentally repeats a word because they ran out of other options, that's a writing mistake, not a device.



You got this!

Look out for the "**rule of three**" — repeating an idea exactly three times ("blood, sweat and tears") is one of the most persuasive patterns in the English language.

5 Quick recap

Repeats on purpose

Builds emphasis

Creates rhythm



Good spot!

Try building a short, powerful sentence using repetition — pick one word and repeat it three times for maximum impact.